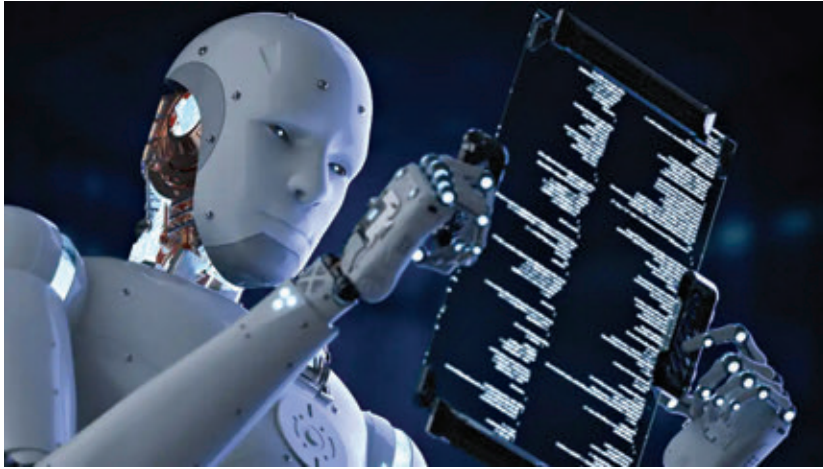




ChatGPT maker's secret tool to detect AI-written text with 99.9% accuracy

Why isn't it released?

Jayesh Shinde | jayesh@digit.in

In what promises to be agonisingly frustrating news for school and college teachers all around the world, OpenAI possesses a technology capable of reliably identifying text generated by ChatGPT with up to 99.9% accuracy, including essays and research papers. And despite widespread concerns over academic dishonesty involving AI-generated text by students trying to cut corners, the company hasn't publicly released this AI-generated text detection tool. Sounds unbelievable, right?

According to a WSJ report, release of the AI text detection tool has been delayed till now because of internal disputes at OpenAI – a lack of consensus from the ChatGPT maker has

stalled the release of this technology for approximately two years, believe it or not. According to informed sources and internal documents, accessed by the WSJ, the disruptive tool has been ready and prepared for deployment for nearly a year. It can go live as soon as possible, if OpenAI chooses to give it the green light.

This is quite something, if you think about it: Where on one hand OpenAI has been accelerating release of whole new products like Sora (text-to-video AI video generation model) and SearchGPT (AI-powered search engine similar to ChatGPT) in the last few months, on top of launching GPT-4 and GPT-4o models, but the same company doesn't want to release this AI-generated text detection tool. Maybe Sam Altman and other

OpenAI head honchos need to attend a PTA meeting in a nearby high school?

AI-generated text fooling teachers

The number of school and university students using AI chatbot tools like ChatGPT and others to generate essays, coursework and homework is only rising – there's plenty of surveys and studies indicating this trend. According to a survey report, 56% of college students have admitted using AI tools on their assignments or exams. And over half of the over 1000 students surveyed (54%) considered the use of AI tools on college coursework as cheating or plagiarism.

With this tsunami of AI-generated content coming their way, teachers are none the wiser in terms of identifying the difference between an originally written essay versus paragraphs of text that's AI generated, according to a research study evaluating teachers' ability to detect AI content. Broad findings of the study suggest that teachers are overconfident in their ability to detect AI-generated texts, that both novice and experienced teachers struggle to find the difference between AI-generated texts and original student-written essays.

The most concerning result of the study is that teachers tend to rate AI-generated high-quality texts more favourably than student-written ones, showing a bias towards perceived quality over actual source detection – which means a student who pains-takingly does their homework and research to write an essay or paper in their own words can get lesser marks than someone else who ChatGPT's the same task, because of the teachers' bias. Clearly, this is a problem – one that can't be solved just by banning the use of ChatGPT or other AI-based text content generation tools.

Of course, OpenAI and ChatGPT aren't wholly responsible for the invasion of AI-powered tools into highschool or university students' lives, even though the teaching and academic com-